9U BASEBALL PLAYER HITTING ASSESSMENT FORM

Player Name: _____ **Date:** _____

Age: _____ **Team:** _____ **Position(s):** _____

Coach: _____ **Assessment #:** _____ (Initial/Follow-up)

PHASE 1: PLAYER COMMUNICATION & UNDERSTANDING

Player's Perspective

Ask these questions to understand the player's thoughts on their hitting. For younger players, simplify as needed.

What do you feel you do well?

_____

_____

What do you feel you struggle with?

_____

_____

What are your big focal points when hitting?

_____

_____

What do you think is the #1 thing we need to work on?

_____

_____

Terminology Understanding

Check the player's understanding of common terms you use. Note what these mean to them.

"Staying inside the ball" means: _____

"Staying back" means: _____

Other key terms they use: _____

Player Goals & Role

Batting order position (typical): _____

Type of hitter they want to be:

- ☐ Contact/On-base
- ☐ Power

- [ ] Line-drive
- [ ] Other: _____

Pre-at-bat routine: _____

On-deck routine: _____

PHASE 2: INITIAL OBSERVATION

General Impressions

Watch the player hit without immediate correction. Note your initial observations.

Overall athleticism (1-5): _____ **Rhythm/tempo (1-5):** _____

Initial swing observations (check all that apply):

- [ ] Good bat speed
- [ ] Consistent contact
- [ ] Balanced finish
- [ ] Good rhythm
- [ ] Confident approach
- [ ] Drops barrel
- [ ] Casts hands
- [ ] Lunges forward
- [ ] Poor timing
- [ ] Pulls off ball
- [ ] Stiff/mechanical

Other observations:

_____

_____

_____

PHASE 3: VIDEO & DATA ANALYSIS

Video Analysis

Record from multiple angles and review with player. Note differences between what they feel and what's happening.

Video angles used:

- [ ] Side view
- [ ] Rear view

- ☐ Front view
- ☐ Other: _____

Key video observations:

_____
_____
_____

Player's reaction to video:

_____
_____

Data Analysis (if available)

Record any metrics from tools like HitTrax, if used.

Exit velocity (avg): _____ **Launch angle (avg):** _____

Other metrics: _____

Performance by pitch location (note strengths/weaknesses):

- Inside: _____
- Middle: _____
- Outside: _____
- Up: _____
- Down: _____

PHASE 4: DETAILED MECHANICAL ASSESSMENT

Pre-Swing Setup

Grip:

- ☐ Proper (fingers, knuckles aligned)
- ☐ Too deep in palms
- ☐ Too tight
- ☐ Improper knuckle alignment
- ☐ Other issue: _____

Notes: _____

Stance:

- ☐ Athletic
- ☐ Too narrow

- [ ] Too wide
- [ ] Poor weight distribution
- [ ] Too far from plate
- [ ] Too close to plate
- [ ] Other issue: _____

Notes: _____

Load & Stride

Rhythm/Timing:

- [ ] Consistent rhythm
- [ ] Inconsistent timing
- [ ] Starts too early
- [ ] Starts too late
- [ ] No rhythm (static)
- [ ] Other issue: _____

Notes: _____

Load:

- [ ] Good load into back hip/leg
- [ ] No load
- [ ] Excessive load
- [ ] Falls forward early
- [ ] Loads away from plate
- [ ] Other issue: _____

Notes: _____

Stride:

- [ ] Good direction
- [ ] Too long
- [ ] Too short
- [ ] Stride direction issue
- [ ] Poor timing with pitch
- [ ] Other issue: _____

Notes: _____

Connection & Bat Path

Connection:

- [ ] Maintains good connection
- [ ] Hands/barrel disconnect from body
- [ ] Casts hands out
- [ ] Back arm drops early
- [ ] Other issue: _____

Notes: _____

Bat Path:

- [ ] Good path through zone
- [ ] Too steep (chopping)
- [ ] Too flat
- [ ] Looping
- [ ] Barrel drops below hands
- [ ] Other issue: _____

Notes: _____

Direction:

- [ ] Good direction through the ball
- [ ] Pulls across body
- [ ] Rolls over
- [ ] Cuts off swing
- [ ] Other issue: _____

Notes: _____

Lower Half & Turn

Hip Drive/Turn:

- [ ] Good hip rotation
- [ ] Poor hip drive
- [ ] Spins out
- [ ] Hips block rotation
- [ ] Poor stability
- [ ] Other issue: _____

Notes: _____

Sequence:

- ☐ Good sequence (lower half first)
- ☐ Upper body leads
- ☐ Hands start too early
- ☐ No separation
- ☐ Other issue: _____

Notes: _____

Posture:

- ☐ Maintains good posture
- ☐ Stands up during swing
- ☐ Dips shoulders
- ☐ Leans back
- ☐ Lunges forward
- ☐ Other issue: _____

Notes: _____

Contact & Finish

Contact Position:

- ☐ Good palm up/palm down at contact
- ☐ Proper contact point for pitch location
- ☐ Early wrist roll
- ☐ Poor hand position
- ☐ Other issue: _____

Notes: _____

Finish & Balance:

- ☐ Balanced finish
- ☐ Falls forward
- ☐ Falls backward
- ☐ Spins out
- ☐ Short/incomplete swing
- ☐ Other issue: _____

Notes: _____

PHASE 5: APPROACH & MENTAL ASSESSMENT

Pitch Recognition:

- ☐ Tracks ball well
- ☐ Recognizes pitch types
- ☐ Struggles with off-speed
- ☐ Difficulty seeing ball
- ☐ Other issue: _____

Notes: _____

Pitch Selection:

- ☐ Swings at good pitches
- ☐ Chases bad pitches
- ☐ Takes too many strikes
- ☐ Other issue: _____

Notes: _____

Situational Awareness:

- ☐ Understands situation
- ☐ Adjusts approach appropriately
- ☐ Lacks situational understanding
- ☐ Other issue: _____

Notes: _____

Confidence:

- ☐ Confident approach
- ☐ Tentative
- ☐ Affected by failure
- ☐ Other issue: _____

Notes: _____

Mental Approach:

- ☐ Good focus
- ☐ Overthinks

- [ ] Rushes
- [ ] Too many thoughts
- [ ] Other issue: _____

Notes: _____

PHASE 6: INDIVIDUALIZED DEVELOPMENT PLAN

Root Causes Identified

List the fundamental issues (not just symptoms) that need addressing, in priority order:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Recommended Drills & Focus Areas

Select 2-3 specific drills that address the root causes identified above:

Drill 1: _____
Purpose: _____
Home Practice? Yes [ ] No [ ]

Drill 2: _____
Purpose: _____
Home Practice? Yes [ ] No [ ]

Drill 3: _____
Purpose: _____
Home Practice? Yes [ ] No [ ]

Development Progression

Starting with:

- [ ] Tee work
- [ ] Soft toss
- [ ] Front toss
- [ ] Other: _____

Progression timeline: _____

Feel Cues & Communication

Simple, clear cues to give the player based on their understanding:

Primary cue: _____

Secondary cue: _____

Visual/feeling to focus on: _____

Equipment Recommendations

Any specific training aids that would help:

- ☐ Connection ball
- ☐ Rope bat
- ☐ Mini bat/short bat
- ☐ PVC pipe
- ☐ Dodgeball (for shoulder drills)
- ☐ Other: _____

Follow-up Assessment

Scheduled date: _____

Specific metrics to track: _____

COACH'S REFERENCE GUIDE: COMMON ISSUES & DRILLS

Load & Timing Issues

- **Not getting loaded/Falling forward:** Feet Together Drill, Cross-Foot Drill
- **Poor rhythm/timing:** Skater/Step-Back Drill, Walk-in Drill
- **Spinning backward:** Kickback/Scissor Kick Drill
- **Poor balance:** Balance Beam Drill, Freeze on Finish

Connection & Bat Path Issues

- **Disconnected swing/Casting:** Connection Ball Drill, Bat on Neck Drill, Dodgeball on Shoulder
- **Steep path/Barrel drop:** Two Tee Drill, High Tee Drill, PVC Pipe Sequence
- **Staying inside the ball:** Fence Drill, Robinson Cano (Net) Drill
- **Pulling across body:** Hitting Disc Drill, Outside Tee Drill
- **Dragging back elbow:** Knob Drill, Rear Hand Chop, Directional Drill
- **Poor direction:** Tire Drill, Directional Tee Work (target practice)

Lower Half & Turn Issues

- **Poor hip rotation/drive:** Dumbbell Turn, PVC Pipe Hip Turn
- **Poor sequence:** PVC Pipe Across Shoulders, Med Ball Rotation
- **Staying in posture:** Wall Drill, Head on Tee
- **Balance issues:** Bucket Drill, Stick It Drill, Balance Launch

Pitch Recognition & Approach Issues

- **Pitch tracking:** Mini Ball Tracking
- **Pitch recognition:** Colored Ball Drill, 6-Ball Location Drill
- **Poor pitch selection:** Situational BP, Location-Specific Tee Work
- **Situational hitting:** Outside Tee Drill (with target), Runner on 2nd BP

Important Notes for 9U

- Keep explanations simple and focus on feel
- Make drills fun and game-like when possible
- Encourage confidence and minimize fear of failure
- Balance mechanical work with game approach
- Provide lots of repetition with quality feedback
- Progress from isolated mechanics to game-like situations
- Emphasize tracking the ball and contact quality

PARENT COMMUNICATION

Key points discussed with parents:

_____

_____

Home practice recommendations:

_____

_____

_____

Completed by: _____ *Date:* _____

Next assessment date: _____